

Chapter-7 *Finite and Non-Finite Forms of Verbs*

Read the following forms of the verbs carefully:

- ✦ Go, goes, went, gone, going, to go, having gone
- ✦ Look, looks, looked, looking, to look, having looked
- ✦ Help, helps, helped, helping, to help, having helped
- ✦ Be, is, am, are, was, were, to be, been, being, having been
- ✦ Do, does, did, done, doing, to do, having done
- ✦ Has, have, had, to have, having, having had

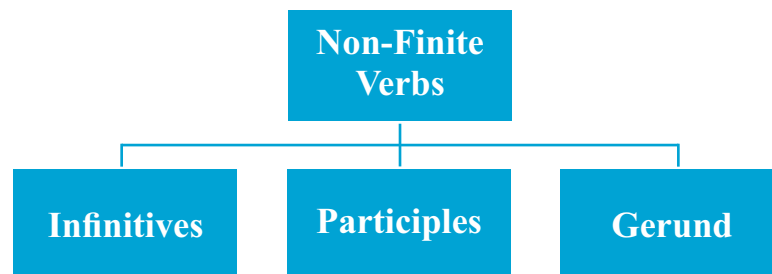
Think: Why do we use different forms of verbs in sentences?

Look at the changes in the forms of verbs in the following sentences:

1. He **goes** to school *to study*.
They **go** to school *to study*. (Change in number of the subject)
2. I **will** *help* you. (Determination)
I **may** *help* you. (Possibility) (Change in expression/mood)
3. They **like** *swimming*.
They **liked** *swimming*. (Change in tense)
4. He **finds** the door *locked*.
I **find** the door *locked*. (Change in person of the subject)

The verbs in blue font in the above sentences are called finite verbs or finite forms of verbs because these verbs change their forms according to change in tense, number, mood or person. The verbs in italic font don't change their forms according to change in tense, number, mood or person. These verbs are called non-finite forms of verbs.

Types of Non-Finite Verbs



Infinitives

An infinitive is a type of non-finite form of verb that does not follow subject-verb agreement in the sentence. It is the first form of verb used with 'to' or without 'to'.

There are two types of Infinitives.

1. **Infinitive with 'to': 'to' + first form of verb'**

Examples:

- (a) He goes to school to study. (b) I wanted to play. (c) They wish to join a new school.

In the above sentences, the verbs, 'to study', 'to play' and 'to join' are infinitives with 'to'.

2. **Infinitive without 'to' (Bare Infinitive): First form of verb**

Examples:

- (a) Please let me go. (b) I will help you. (c) She does nothing but complain.

In the above sentences, the verbs, 'go', 'help' and 'complain' are infinitives without 'to' or bare infinitives.

Infinitives with 'to'

Read the following examples carefully to understand the use of infinitive with 'to'.

1. To err is human. (used as a subject)
2. I want to go there. (used as an object)
3. My ambition is to become a doctor. (used as a subject complement)
4. It is easier to preach than to practise. (used after an adjective)
5. He went to meet the President. (used to modify a verb)
6. You are difficult to please. (used to modify an adjective)
7. It is time to leave. (used to modify a noun)
8. To cut the long story short, he cheated everybody (used as a comment)
9. He is about to resign. (used after a preposition)
10. He was the first to arrive. (used as an adjunct)
11. The patient is too weak to walk. (used with adverb 'too')
12. I don't have money enough to buy a car. (used with adjective 'enough')

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with infinitives with 'to' using the verbs given in the brackets.

1. others is easy. (criticize)
2. Give me something..... (eat)
3. She was the only one..... this sum. (solve)
4. The movie is too boring..... (watch)
5. He is aboutfor Mumbai. (leave)
6.you the truth, I don't like your dress. (tell)
7. It is time.....the lessons. (revise)
8. I wish.....driving. (learn)
9. My dream isa singer. (become)
10. It is easier.....than to do. (say)

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with infinitives with 'to' using the verbs given in the brackets. The first example has been done for you.

1. I hope to stand first in the class this year. (stand)
2. You deserve.....(get) this award.
3. I was late, so I decided(take) a taxi.
4. He cannot afford.....(buy) an expensive mobile phone.
5. I have managed.....(collect) some money for my new house.
6. My friend has promised.....(help) me.
7. My neighbour agreed(give) me a lift in his car.
8. Last year we planned(visit) Agra.
9. He worked hard, but failed.....(get) good marks.
10. Rajat refused(lend) me money.

11. The child seems(have) no interest in this game.
12. You appear.....(be) tired.
13. The boy pretended(be) sleeping.
14. This girl tends.....(talk) a lot.
15. Our country rightly claims.....(have) a rich heritage.

Infinitive without 'to' (Bare Infinitive)

Bare Infinitive is used in the following cases:

(1) After the auxiliary 'do', 'does' or 'did':

- (i) He does not like mangoes. (ii) They did not stay here. (iii) Do you have a spare pen?

(2) After modal auxiliaries:

- (i) I will help you. (ii) He may come tomorrow. (iii) You need not go there.

(3) After certain verbs such as: see, watch, hear, feel, let, make, help, bid, have:

- (i) I saw her make a doll. (ii) They watched us play football. (iii) She hears him sing a song.

(4) After certain phrases such as: had better, had rather, would better, would rather

- (i) I would better stay where I am. (ii) He would rather die than beg.

(5) After 'but', 'except' and 'than' such as:

- (i) She does nothing but complain. (ii) I would better talk than remain silent.

(6) In suggestions starting with why or why not:

- (i) Why talk to him? (ii) Why not go there and talk to him?

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with 'infinitives with to' or 'bare infinitives' using the verbs given in the brackets.

1.is human. (err)
2. You cannot..... my class. (attend)
3. Let me.....a question. (ask)
4. My teacher made mein the class. (stand)
5. Please help me.....this box. (lift)
6. You should.....some rest. (take)
7. You need not..... her. (invite)
8. You had better.....silent than..... (remain, argue)
9. We must.....the patient to the hospital. (take)
10. I watched her.....the road. (cross)
11. I want.....a teacher. (become)
12. We don't know how..... her. (help)
13. He wantsthe truth. (hear)
14. I have nothing new..... (tell)
15. Why.....time in this discussion? (waste)

Note : Verbs that take infinitive as object : attempt, ask, agree, claim, choose, consent, decide , deserve, determine, expect, hope, learn, long, manage, mean, offer, pretend, prepare, seem etc.

Participles

A participle is a type of non-finite form of verb that does not follow subject-verb agreement in the sentence. Participles are the verbs that function as adjectives. They are also called verbal adjectives. There are three types of participles.

- (i) Present Participle (first form of verb + 'ing' functioning as an adjective)
- (ii) Past Participle (third form of verb functioning as an adjective)
- (iii) Perfect Participle (having + third form of verb functioning as an adjective)

Use of Present Participles

We use a present participle (first form of verb+ ‘ing’) to describe or modify a noun or a pronoun. A present participle can be placed before or after the noun or pronoun it modifies. Read the sentences given below to understand the use of present participles.

- ✧ I will buy a jumping doll. (used as an adjective)
- ✧ This building has no running water. (used as an adjective)
- ✧ The lecture was interesting. (used as a subject complement)
- ✧ We saw the moon rising. (used as an object complement)
- ✧ She went away crying. (used as an adverb)
- ✧ The person living on the first floor is my friend. (used as an adjective phrase)
- ✧ Placing his hand on the Bible, he took the oath. (used to denote earlier action of the same subject)
- ✧ It being a fine day, we arranged for a picnic. (used as an absolute phrase)

Use of Past Participle

We use a past participle (third form of verb) to describe or modify a noun or a pronoun. A past participle can be placed before or after the noun or pronoun it modifies. Read the sentences given below to understand the use of past participles.

- ✧ A burnt child dreads the fire. (used as an adjective)
- ✧ He appears bored. (used as a subject complement)
- ✧ I found him tired. (used as an object complement)
- ✧ The shop has been inaugurated now. (used in passive voice)
- ✧ The man seems worried. (used as a subject complement)
- ✧ They have finished their meal. (used in perfect tense)
- ✧ The books read in childhood are forgotten. (used in an adjective phrase)
- ✧ Deceived by his friends, he killed himself. (used in an adjective Phrase)
- ✧ The man left the hospital completely cured. (used as an adverb)

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with ‘present participle’ or ‘past participle’ forms of the verbs given in the bracket.

1. The(rise) sun looks beautiful.
2. He jumped out of the(move) train.
3. The long journey was(tire).
4.(defeat) by the enemy, the soldiers fled.
5. They want their house.....(paint).
6. The girl sat there.....(sing) to herself.

7. We found the terms.....(tempt).
8. Time once.....(lose) is.....(lose) forever.
9. God(will), we will meet again.
10.(pick) up his bag, he walked away.
11. They are.....(tire).
12.(take) a gun, he shot at the bird.
13. The boy sat..... (whistle).
14. I found the child(sit) outside.
15. He stood up there..... (wait)for the train.
16. He looked(involve)in the task.
17. The children watched the show..... (amaze).
18. The child..... (wear) the red coat is my son.
19.(Learn) men will never talk much.
20. The.....(wound) man was taken to the hospital.

Use of Perfect Participle

We use a perfect participle (having+ third form of verb) to denote an action which is complete and followed by another action.

- ✧ Having completed my homework, I went to play.
- ✧ Having found the correct answer, the boy was happy.
- ✧ Having helped the poor, I felt overjoyed.
- ✧ Having travelled for a long day, they felt tired.

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with 'perfect participle' forms of the verbs given in the bracket.

1.(finish) his work, the boy sat down to relax.
2.(leave) the tortoise far behind, the hare stopped to rest.
3.(write) some short stories, he started writing a novel.
4.(borrow), money from a lot of people, he ran away from the city.
5.(lose), all his money in gambling he committed suicide.

Gerund

A gerund is the form of the verb which ends in 'ing' and does the function of a noun. That is why; the gerund is called a verbal noun.

Examples:

1. Swimming is a good exercise. (used as a subject)
2. He likes reading books. (used as an object)
3. My passion is teaching. (used as subject complement)
4. I am fond of singing. (used after a preposition)

Use of Gerund

(i) We use a gerund after the verbs given in the box below.

enjoy, consider, admit, allow, regret, keep, involve, imagine, fancy, risk, practise, postpone, stop, finish, resent, resume, delay, prefer, deny, detest, keep, worth, keep up, practise, quit, resist, miss, avoid, like, dread, suggest, forgive, look forward to, give up, put off, mind, can't help, couldn't help, need, no use, be used to, love etc.

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with gerund forms of the verbs given in the brackets. The first example has been solved for you.

1. He has stopped disturbing me. (disturb)
2. My brother enjoys.....(watch) horror movies.
3. She loves.....(listen) to music.
4. I don't mind your.....(take) my pen.
5. The baby dreads(go) near the dog.
6. He finished.....(type) the letter.
7. Please forgive my.....(talk) rudely to you.
8. It's no use.....for them anymore. (wait)
9. I am looking forward to(meet) you.
10. She admitted.....(have) stolen the money.
11. Kim suggested.....(go) to cinema.
12. I regret.....(say) all that to you.
13. Keep.....(work) hard to get success.
14. Have you ever considered.....(write) stories for movies?
15. He has given up.....(smoke).
16. I am used to(deal) with such people.
17. I prefer..... (read)to.....(write).
18. That place is worth.....(visit).
19. He is fed up with.....(travel).
20. This carpet needs.....(dust).

(ii) We also use a gerund after a preposition or a determiner.

Examples:

1. He is fond **of** playing cricket.
2. Are you interested **in** going with us?
3. You must switch off the lights and fans **before** leaving the room.
4. Please don't mind **my** interrupting you.
5. **The** printing of the books will be complete by the next month.

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with gerund forms of the verbs given in the brackets.

1. He is very good at.....(paint).
2. What are the advantages of.....(use) a computer.
3. Kajal went to school in spite of(be) unwell.
4. Your.....the workshop is important. (attend)
5. She worked for ten hours without.....(stop).
6. James has every chance of(win) the competition.
7. I have no intention of.....(lend) you any money.
8. My father prefers driving to(travel) by train.
9. Rajeev is fed up with(attend) meetings.
10. Her..... (win) the lottery is uncertain.
11. My brother was tired after(studying) for ten hours.
12. I bought a new book instead of.....(buy) a new dress.

Note : Verbs that take either infinitive or gerund as object depending on the meaning of the sentence : advise, begin, can't bear, continue, fear, forget, hate, like, love, mean, neglect, remember, regret, start, try recommend etc.

Exercise: Correct the following sentences.

1. Swim is good for health.
2. I am fond of collect old stamps.
3. I could not help laugh.
4. See is believe.
5. She had better stayed at home.
6. My brother offered help me.
7. Please explain me how to solving this sum.
8. He could not resist tasted the delicious cake.
9. Ritesh bade me to take his umbrella.
10. It's no use cry over spilt milk.
11. Have said that, he left the room.
12. He risked ventured out in the storm.
13. The Principal appears troubling today.
14. I apologise for my behave rudely.
15. Played on this field is enjoyable.
16. She loves to listen to music.
17. She admitted have stolen the money.